

UR

1830 BC

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A game by Joris Wiersinga and Jeroen Doumen for 3 to 6 players from 14 years. Duration about 4 hours.

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PLAYING MATERIAL

- A game board;
- Water markers (24 blue discs);
- Canal markers (80 blue sticks, but these are intended to be unlimited, use replacement components if they run out);
- Four land price markers (the yellow squares with mountains, trees, grass and sand);
- Ownership markers for six players (the bigger squares);
- 38 cards with waterworks and diggers;
- Sequence markers (hourglasses) and waterworks (showing capacity) in the six colors of the states: Akkad (gray), Babylon (blue), Elam (green), Persia (black), Sumer (yellow) and Urartu (red);
- 6 treasury charts of the states (Akkad, Babylon, Elam, Persia, Sumer, and Urartu);
- 6 independent nation cards (Ashur, Barahshum, Calah, Der, Eridu, and the First Akkadians);
- 1 primogeniture card (the mess of pottage);
- The players must supply a bank. 5,000 Splägels should be sufficient for most games. Poker chips are recommended.

1 INTRODUCTION

1.1 UR, 1830 BC

From the temple, one can see far over the lands of Ur. The king points to teams of men digging near the river. “Look, my son. The men of Kishi are digging a new canal. We shall dispatch some workers to shovel water into it. Make sure they water our lands well.” But I do not listen to the old king. I am contemplating whether to lead my men in founding a new nation closer to the river’s source, or to devote the coming year to science. There are rumors that the Babylonians are experimenting with a wheel that wields water, and my people could use such a contraption. For the Gods have revealed that a great drought will be upon us...

“Ur, 1830 BC” is a game about irrigation in Mesopotamia. It is based lightly on Francis Tresham’s successful series of 18XX train games, of which 1830 is the most famous. As this series is the favorite non-Splotter game of three of Splotter’s designers, we wanted to make a contribution to this great gaming tradition. So here it is!

1.2 GAME OVERVIEW

Each player controls a dynasty in ancient Mesopotamia. The game is played in rounds, each consisting of three phases:

- **Settlement Phase.** Players buy and sell land, trying to settle the areas that will yield most. If the population grows large enough, states emerge.
- **Development Phase.** States build the irrigation works (canals, reservoirs, and pumps)
- **Rainy Season.** Water comes down the rivers and is diverted to be used for irrigation. Each plot of irrigated land yields income to the land owner and to the state that operates the waterworks.

As more and more states are founded, the technological development in waterworks and digging tools drives old equipment out of use. Canals are built faster and faster, land yield goes up, and more and more land becomes available for agriculture.

The board shows spaces with land (desert, forest, hills, and savannah) and rivers depicted on them. Each of these spaces is called an **area**. Groups of adjacent areas of the same land type are called **regions**. Additionally, there are thick colored outlines representing the **states**. All the areas within these outlines are part of the state.

The game involves three levels of strategy: first, smart buying and selling on the land market; second, tactical play developing the right land and canals on the map; and third, strategic anticipation and control of the speed of technological development.

1.3 A NOTE ON TREASURIES

The notion of treasures is vital to this game. There are two kinds of treasures: private and state. Private treasures are controlled by players. They are used to buy and sell land, and count towards victory in the end. State treasures are controlled by monarchs. They can be used to buy waterworks and hire digging crews, and do not count towards victory. It is vital to keep the two separated. State treasures must be placed on a state treasury chart. Private money must be placed on the table in front of the respective player.

All treasures, state and private, may be counted by any player at any time.

2 SETTING UP

Each player chooses a set of ownership markers (the big squares). Split 1800 Splägels evenly among the players (see table). The remaining money forms the bank. Put the map in the middle of the table, and place the four markers indicating land prices on the matching colonization price slots on the land price bar. Put the cards showing digging teams on the slots provided.

Number of players	Amount in Splägels
3	600
4	450
5	360
6	300

Money per player at start of game

Use the independent nation cards to establish turn order. Use the number of cards corresponding to the number of players and deal one card to each player, face down. The initial letters on the cards indicate the order of play (A plays first, then B, et cetera). Players may have to change seats to ensure that play can proceed clockwise. The player who got card A gets the primogeniture card (this is the right-of-birth card, showing a mess of pottage). This player starts the game.

Take back the six independent nation cards and put them on the map in alphabetical order for use in the next part of the game.

3 INDEPENDENT NATIONS

3.1 OVERVIEW

There are six independent nations: Ashur, Barahshum, Calah, Der, Eridu, and First Akkadians. Each nation occupies a piece of land on the board and has a card that details the nation's treaty price, the tribute that it pays its owner, and any special skills that the nation may accord its owner.

At any point during play, each nation is either owned by a player, **assimilated** (owned by a state), or **dissolved** (removed from the game). The nations are divided using the process described below. Later in the game, states may assimilate nations by buying them from their owners (either a player or another state). Some nations provide special skills that require dissolving them; later in the game, all the nations are dissolved.

3.2 DIVIDING THE INDEPENDENT NATIONS

Players take turns in the division of the independent nations. The nations are acquired by players in alphabetical order. When a player takes a turn, the **treaty nation** is the first in order that has not yet been acquired (and is thus ready to be acquired for its treaty price). The player may do one of three things:

- Acquire the treaty nation for its treaty price (but see below if that nation already has an offer).
- Make an offer on another nation later in order.
- Pass (take no action).

To make an offer to a later nation, a player proceeds as follows:

- If there was no offer for that nation, the amount offered must be at least 5 SPL greater than the nation's treaty price. The amount offered and the player's ownership marker are placed below the nation's card.
- If there was already an offer for that nation, the amount offered must be at least 5 SPL greater than the previous offer. The previous offer (but not the ownership marker) is returned to the player who made that offer. The new offer and current player's ownership marker are placed to the right of the highest previous offer.

(In the unlikely event that the player had already made an offer for this nation, move their marker to the right and leave with it the amount of the latest offer. This might be done to change the bidding order in a subsequent auction or to discourage other players from making an offer.)

If there is already an offer for the first available nation when a player's turn would start, the player cannot choose to acquire the nation for its treaty price. Instead, the game is interrupted to allow that nation to be acquired (through the process described below) before the player can take their turn.

If only one player had made an offer on that nation, that player acquires the nation for the amount offered. If more than one player has made an offer, an auction results. The offer of the player whose ownership marker is farthest to the right is the initial bid.

Bidding then proceeds among the players who made offers on the nation in the order determined by their ownership markers (from left to right and then back around). Each bid must be at least 5 SPL higher than the previous. A player may decline to bid, thus dropping out of the auction. When all but one of the bidding players have dropped out, the remaining player acquires the nation for the highest bid. Players retrieve their ownership markers.

The next nation now becomes the treaty nation unless it also has an offer, in which case the process just described repeats. Only when the next nation has no offer does it become the treaty nation and the original player takes a turn.

When a player acquires a nation (through any of the means described above), the player pays the price to the bank, except for First Akkadians; for that nation, the price is paid to the treasury of the state of Akkad.

A player acquiring First Akkadians places three of their ownership markers (face up) on the three Savannah lands that make up that nation. That player also becomes the Monarch of Akkad (rules about Monarchs are given with the settlement phase).

For example, in a 4-player game: Player 1 buys Ashur at 20 SPL. Barahshum is now the treaty nation. Player 2 offers 115 SPL for Der and puts the money aside. Player 3 then offers 120 SPL for Der and puts it aside; player 2 regains use of their 115 SPL. Player 4 offers 175 SPL for Eridu. Player 1 buys Barahshum at 40 SPL; Calah becomes the treaty nation. Player 2 passes. Player 3 buys Calah; players 2 and 3 then bid for Der in an auction, which is won by player 2 at 150 SPL (player 3 gets back their offer of 120 SPL). Eridu then goes to player 4 for 175 SPL, as they were the only one to make an offer. Play proceeds with player 4, as player 3 was the last one to get a treaty nation. Player 4 passes. Player 1 then pays the treaty price of 220 SPL for the First Akkadians to join them.

If all players pass consecutively before all nations are acquired, the following occurs:

- If Ashur is the treaty nation, reduce its price by 5 SPL. If all players again pass consecutively, the price is reduced by another 5 SPL. Once this has happened four times (reducing the price to 0 SPL), the current player acquires Ashur for 0 SPL and the turn passes to the next player.
- If Ashur is not the treaty nation, each player receives from the bank the tribute for each nation that they have already acquired. Play then continues normally (the price of the treaty nation does not change).

If it becomes a player's turn and all independent nations have been acquired (e.g., because there had been offers on all of them), that player takes the primogeniture card and the first round of play begins.

4 SETTLEMENT PHASE

4.1 ORDER OF PLAY

In the settlement phase, players take turns to buy or sell land areas. The player holding the primogeniture card starts, and play proceeds clockwise. Players take turns in this phase as long as any player does something during their turn; the phase ends as soon as all players pass consecutively.

4.2 LAND AREAS AND PRICES

A **land area** (or just “area”) is an area of the map demarcated by thin black lines. There are four types of land indicated on the map: hills, forest, savannah, and desert.

There are also **river areas**, which are the blue areas with a river running through them. Although river areas flow through the states, the states have no entitlements. The river areas are effectively neutral.

Each type of land has a fixed **colonization price** as printed on the land price bar. (As noted in the table, the colonization price of cities differs from that of normal land.) The current **sale price**, which may be higher or lower than the colonization price, is indicated by a marker which moves on the land price bar.

Type of land	Normal land	City land
Hills	100	100
Forest	82	100
Savannah	71	82
Desert	60	71

Colonization prices of different types of land.

Each area also belongs to a state, as indicated by the colored boundaries. There are six states. A state is called **emerging** if fewer than six land areas in that state have been colonized. It becomes **active** at the end of a settlement phase if six or more land areas have been colonized by the end of that phase.

On their turn, a player may either:

- sell as much of their land as they want, and/or buy one area,
- bid for primogeniture,
- or pass.

4.3 BUYING LAND

In a turn of a settlement phase, a player may buy one land area. They may do so before or after selling land. They may also sell, buy, and sell again during a turn. Players in order may take multiple turns within a settlement phase and may buy up to one land area per turn, but may sell multiple areas each turn.

To buy a land area that has never been bought or sold (such land will have no ownership marker on it), a player pays the fixed colonization price printed on the price bar into the treasury of the state in which the land lies.

To buy land that was bought and later sold (such land will have a flipped-over counter on it), a player pays to the bank the current sale price indicated by the marker on the price bar. (See 4.7, City Prices, for an exception.) The flipped-over counter is returned to its owner.

The buyer places one of their ownership markers on the land that they bought. If the buyer has no counters left to do so, they cannot buy the land. It is not allowed to take back flipped-over counters from sold land until that land is bought by another player.

A player may not buy:

- land that belongs to other players;
- river areas;
- land of a type that player has already sold during the current settlement phase;
- land in an independent nation that is owned by a player;
- land of any type in an emerging state whose land that player has already sold during the current settlement phase (see 4.8, Emerging States).

Example: Player 1 sells a desert in Elam, which is still emerging as only four pieces of land have been sold so far. They also sell a desert in Babylon, which is already active. For the remainder of this phase, they may no longer buy any deserts, nor any land in Elam. They may, however, buy savannah or forest in Babylon (which was already active) or anywhere else. They may sell whatever they buy in the same turn, or later in the phase. Of course, they may also hang on to their investments.

4.4 SELLING LAND

On their turn, a player may sell land. To do so, they may perform one or more selling actions, in each action, selling one or more land areas of one type. A player may perform multiple selling actions for a particular type of land in one turn.

To sell land, a player flips over their ownership marker(s) on the land sold to indicate it is no longer theirs. In return, they get the price indicated by the current price marker of that type of land from the bank. If, in one selling action, a player sells more than one area, they get the indicated amount for each area before prices are changed.

After each selling action, the price of that land type drops one box per area sold, up to a maximum of three boxes. If the original land price was above the shaded area, it will not drop further than the first box of the shaded area. If the land price was already in the shaded area before the selling action, it drops by only one box per action, independent of the amount of land sold.

A player may not sell the last player-owned area in a state (whether active or emerging).

Example: Player 1 wants to sell five hill areas currently valued at 100. On their turn, they may sell all five in one action, receiving 500 SPL and lowering the price by three steps to 76. Alternatively, they may sell three of the hill areas, receiving 300 SPL and lowering the price to 76, and then sell the remaining two, receiving an additional 152 SPL and lowering the price further to 67.

4.5 BIDDING FOR PRIMOGENITURE

The primogeniture card gives a player the right to start the next settlement phase. A player may bid for primogeniture instead of buying and selling. The amount must be higher than the previous amount bid (if any). After bidding, the player takes the primogeniture card and puts their bid on it, returning any previous bid to the appropriate player.

At the end of the settlement phase, the player with the primogeniture card takes their bid back (no money is paid to the bank) and keeps the card. If no player bids for primogeniture, the card remains with its current owner.

The owner of the primogeniture starts the settlement phase of the next round.

4.6 PASS

A player may also pass. If all players pass consecutively, the settlement phase ends and the development phase begins. If, however, another player buys land, sells land, or bids for primogeniture, the passing player will get another turn.

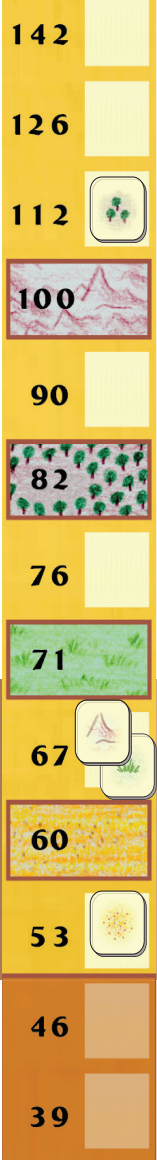
4.7 CITY PRICES

Cities are indicated on the map with a Ziggurat (an ancient religious structure, resembling a pyramid). Cities yield more than ordinary land, but they are also more expensive. They are priced equal to the next highest land price on the price bar (or the highest if there is none). So:

- The colonization prices follow the table in section 4.2, Land Areas and Prices, where a desert city is as expensive as savannah, a savannah city is as expensive as forest, and both forest and hill cities are valued as hills.
- The current sale price follows that of the next highest marker if there is one. The highest marker specifies the price for normal land and city land of that type.

Example (see picture): The desert marker is at 53; the savannah and hills markers are at 67; the forest marker is at 112. Desert cities are now worth 67 (next highest price). Savannah and hill cities are worth 112 (next highest marker), as are forest cities (no higher marker present).

As with normal land, if a city land is sold, the price of that type of land drops. Thus, selling a desert city will decrease the price of deserts, but it might not decrease the price of desert cities. (The price of desert cities may be determined by the next highest marker.) The rules pertaining to buying and selling land types remain the same regardless of the presence of cities.



City prices example

4.8 EMERGING STATES

Colonizing an area increases the population of the state that the area is in. At the start of the game, all states are **emerging**; they are minor entities with no centralized tax revenues.

A state becomes **active** if six pieces of its land have been colonized (i.e. there is a marker on it, either flipped or unflipped) at the end of a settlement phase. States do not become active during a settlement phase. Only active states participate in the development phase.

Once a state is active, it cannot become emerging again.

4.9 MONARCHS

States are controlled by monarchs who take all the actions and make decisions on behalf of the states. The first player to acquire land in a state becomes its monarch. To indicate this, give the treasury chart of the state to the current monarch.

If a player buys land in a state so that they have more than the current monarch, they become the new monarch. The treasury should change accordingly.

If a monarch sells land in their state so that they own less than another player, they must hand the treasury chart to the player who now has the most land. If multiple such players tie, the tied player who is first in clockwise order from the previous monarch becomes the new monarch.

5 DEVELOPMENT PHASE

5.1 ORDER OF PLAY

In the development phase, monarchs decide on actions of their states. Only active states get a turn.

The development phase consists of three parts.

1. All independent nations contribute income to their owner.
2. The player or state owning Eridu may dig a canal using a 2-digger (see the next section for details).
3. Active states may develop their land. Each state may do the following (in the order indicated):
 - I. build canals;
 - II. construct waterworks, hire digging crews, and assimilate independent nations.

Each active state takes a turn in a development phase.

5.1.1 Independent Nations

Each independent nation contributes the amount indicated on its card to its owner from the bank. If it is owned by a player, it pays to the owning player. If it is assimilated, it pays to the owning state's treasury. The money is paid from the bank. (No money is paid by dissolved nations.)

5.1.2 States

The order in which active states play depends on the amount of land owned by the players, that is, containing non-flipped markers (land that was sold but not yet bought again does not count here). The state of which the smallest amount of land is owned

plays first. In case of a tie between two or more states, their order is indicated on the playing board: the state with the lowest number plays first. Note that emerging states do not play at all in the development phase.

The order in which active states play is determined at the start of the development phase and does not change during the phase, even if land may occasionally be sold during the phase. At the beginning of each development phase, place the states' hour-glass markers in the row at the top of the board to indicate the playing order.

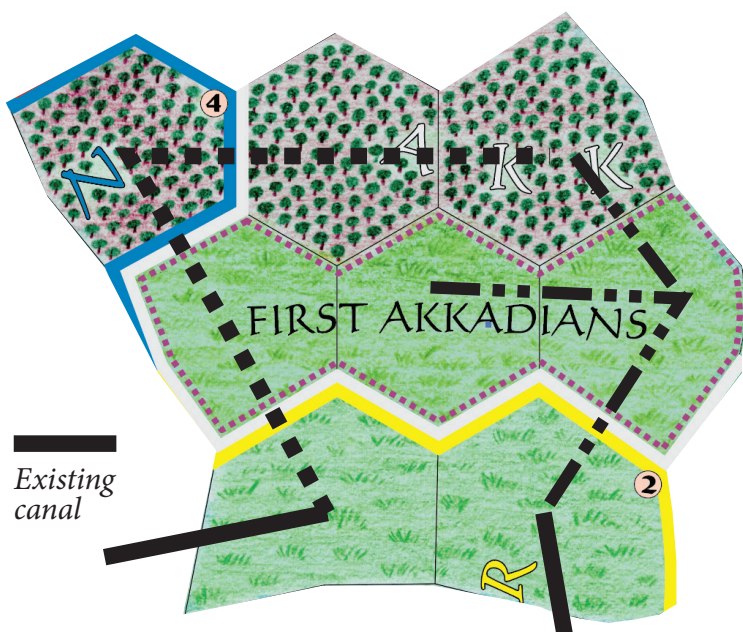
5.2 DIGGING CANALS

To dig a canal, a state must have a digging crew. Since these can only be hired after digging canals, according to the order of play, a newly active state can never build canals in its first turn.

The board already contains a few canals. More canals are dug by placing wood canal markers on the board to connect two areas. A canal may be dug from the center of any area already containing a river or canal to the center of any neighboring area. All canals and rivers in a particular area are always connected to each other. Canals can run in circles, or connect two rivers. They cannot run off the board.

The number on a digging crew's card is the amount of digging points it may use each turn. Digging one canal costs one digging point. So, a 3-digging crew may dig three canals, connecting four areas. The stretch dug by a crew in a particular turn must form one line. A crew does not have to use all its digging points.

The stretch dug by each crew in a particular turn must form one sequence of areas called a **path**. An area may not be repeated in a path, and none of the areas in a path can belong to an independent nation owned by a player. If an independent nation has been assimilated by a state or dissolved, any crew may dig on its land. For the rest, crews may dig anywhere else on the board, even on land belonging to other players, and within the borders of other states.



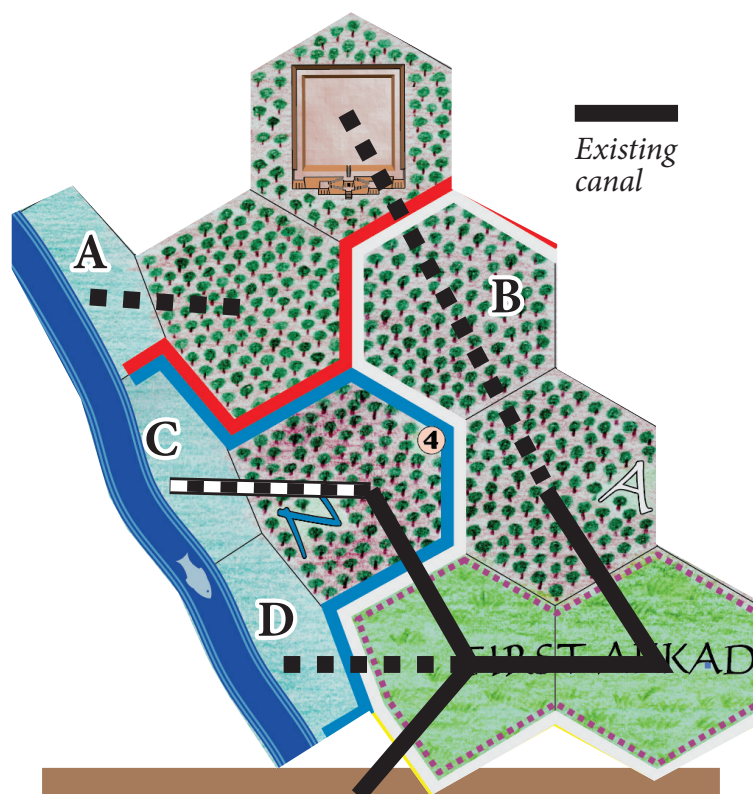
Digging example 1. A state has a 4-digging team. Digging the - - - - line is allowed. Digging the - - - - canals is not, as they do not run in one line.

If a digging crew starts or ends on a river area, or on land already connected to two or more lands, the crew must build a junction point. Each junction costs one extra digging point. Junctions can only be made at the start or the end of the stretch dug by a crew in a particular turn. Junctions in the middle of a stretch are not allowed. Digging a canal which starts and ends on the same piece of land is not allowed, nor is it allowed to dig a canal which ends in a Y-junction with itself. One cannot make a junction without a canal; nor is it possible to combine two crews to let one make a junction and the other the canal.

If the path contains only two areas, they cannot both be river areas, and they cannot already be connected by a canal. If the path contains more than two areas, all areas besides the start and the end must be land areas without a canal.

A digging crew can build a canal on a path only if it has sufficient digging points to do so:

- A 1+1 digging crew has 1 digging point that can be used for a canal, and 1 digging point that can be used for a junction.
- A 2/3/4 digging crew provides 2/3/4 digging points.



Digging example 2.

- To dig A costs 2 points: one for the river junction, one for the canal. It can be built by any team.
- To build B costs 2 points, for two stretches of canal. It can be built by a 2-team or higher. There are no junctions.
- To build C costs 2 points: one for the junction, one for the canal. There is no junction on the right.
- To build D costs 3 points: one for the canal, two for the junctions. It can be built by a 3-team or higher.

- A M(ass) digging crew can dig a canal of any length along any legal path.

In a particular turn, each digging crew can build canals for only one path. Multiple digging crews cannot combine their points to build canals for a single path.

5.3 CONSTRUCTING WATERWORKS AND HIRING DIGGING CREWS

Apart from canals, a state can construct two types of waterworks: reservoirs and pumps. It can also hire digging crews. These are represented by cards. Although a state can buy any number of cards and use them in any combination, it must always buy the most primitive cards available first. Thus, all 2/1/1+1-cards must be sold before the 4/2/2-cards become available.

If a state buys a card, it must immediately decide whether to use it as a reservoir, a pump, or a digging crew.

5.3.1 Constructing Waterworks

Reservoirs and pumps are the two types of waterworks that can be constructed. Reservoirs are built on river areas and pumps are built on land areas. They are represented by the same tokens, but the number on the token is interpreted differently: reservoirs

can pump the *indicated amount* of water *one step* to a neighboring land, provided a canal is present. Pumps may distribute *any amount* of water up to the *indicated distance*, measured by the number of canals it is routed through.

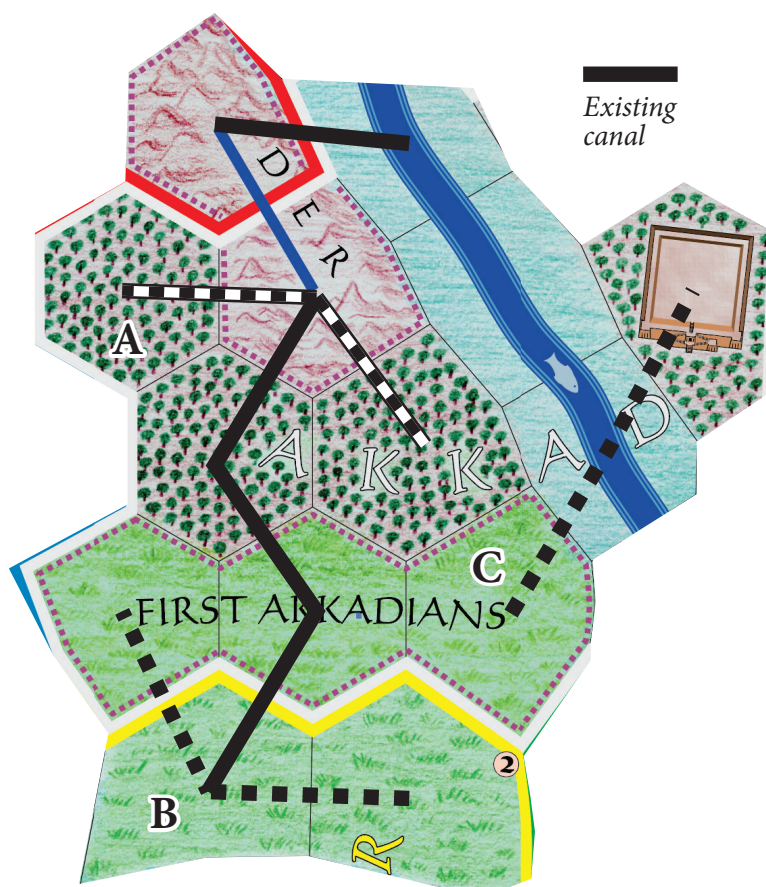
If a state has no tokens left to represent a waterwork with the specified number, it cannot buy such a waterwork.

Pumps and reservoirs, once built, cannot be moved or removed except as a consequence of storing a harvest (see 6.2.1, Storing or Distributing the Harvests). They cannot be upgraded.

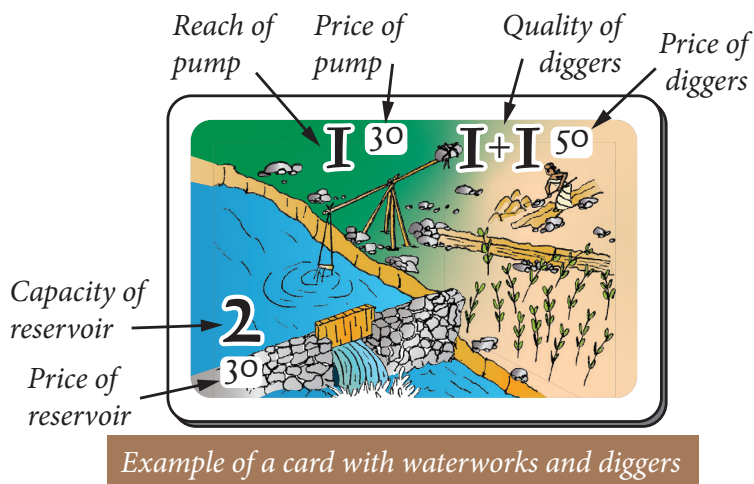
5.3.1.1 Reservoirs

A reservoir can only be placed on river areas. It may even be placed on a river area within another state's territory. A river area cannot contain more than one reservoir. If the river area has a confluence (where two rivers meet), the reservoir must be placed downstream of the confluence.

The capacity of a reservoir is the large number indicated in the lower left corner of the card and the smaller number next to it indicates its price. The state pays the price of the reservoir from its treasury to the bank. The state's monarch then places a reservoir marker of the state's color and of the matching capacity on a river area. After the marker has been placed, the card is put in the box.



Digging example 3. No digging team may dig A, B, or C in one turn, as this would create a junction in the middle of a stretch. However, a player could have one team dig half of the stretch, including junctions as needed, then another team could dig the other half of the stretch, including a junction to connect it to the first half.



Example of a card with waterworks and diggers

5.3.1.2 Pumps

A pump can be placed on any land area that does not already contain one. In areas belonging to an independent nation, a pump can be placed only after that nation has been assimilated or has dissolved. If the area is owned by a player, that player may deny permission to build the pump on their land. Pumps can be built on areas containing canals and on areas that are still devoid of water. They can also be built outside of the state's territory.

The reach of a pump is indicated by the large number in the upper left corner of the card and the small number next to it indicates its price. The state pays the price of the pump from its treasury to the bank. The state's monarch places a pump marker of the state's color and of the matching capacity on the area. After the marker has been placed, the card is put in the box.

5.3.2 Hiring Digging Crews

If the state uses the card to hire a digging crew, the card is placed in the state's treasury. The digging crew's digging points (see 5.2, Digging Canals) is indicated by the large number in the top right corner of the card and the smaller number next to it indicates its price. The state pays the price of the digging crew from its treasury to the bank.

5.4 DAWN OF A NEW ERA

When the first card of a particular set is bought, a new era of technology starts. The amount of water available and the harvest per area depend on the current era.

As soon as the third era starts, all 1+1-digging crews leave; they are no longer willing to work with the old tools. The cards are placed in the box and will no longer be used. The state that has started the third era may immediately assimilate independent nations (see Assimilating Independent Nations).

At the start of the fourth era, all 2-digging crews leave. In addition, all independent nations dissolve forever. Their cards are put in the box.

At the start of the final era (Millennium era), all 3-digging crews leave. Their cards are put in the box.

5.5 CANAL MAINTENANCE AND REVOLUTION

An active state is required always to have a digging crew to perform maintenance on existing canals and river beds. This crew must be present at the end of a state's turn. A state which has just become active, or which has lost its digging crews at the dawn of a new era, has to hire a digging crew in its next turn.

If the state treasury does not suffice to hire a digging crew, the monarch must pay the difference from their personal treasury. If this is also not enough, they must immediately sell land until they have enough money to pay. If the monarch cannot raise the money, a revolution occurs. The monarch must then sell all the land they can, and forfeits all their money to the bank. The game ends after the next rainy season. During that rainy season, the state in which a revolution has occurred will function normally; its harvest will always be distributed. The former monarch gets their share of the harvest as usual.

If the monarch is forced to sell land, they may not sell land if that would cause someone else to become monarch of the revolting state. (It is allowed to sell land that would change the ownership of other states.) Although they may freely choose which lands to sell, they must stop selling as soon as they have raised enough money to hire the digging crew. The cash left after having hired the digging crew must be less than the price of the cheapest land sold. The monarch keeps this as personal money.

The monarch is allowed to use the state treasury to assimilate nations or buy waterworks first, even if this forces them into an insolvent position they could otherwise have avoided. It is not allowed to use any personal money or money from land sold to buy waterworks or second digging crews, however.

Land prices are adjusted as normal (see 4.4, Selling Land). Although the monarch of the current state cannot change, the monarchy of other states may pass on to other players as a result of these sales. The order in which states play is not affected.

5.6 ASSIMILATING INDEPENDENT NATIONS

An active state can assimilate independent nations by buying them from their owners.

The assimilating state and the current 'owner' of the nation must agree on a price that is at least half the nation's treaty price and at most twice that price. The assimilating state pays that price from its treasury to the 'owner' (to the owning player's private treasury or the owning state's treasury, as appropriate). After a nation has been assimilated it cannot be given or sold back to a player.

This action may only be taken during the state's turn in the development phase after the dawn of the third era (that is, after the first 3-card has been sold). As soon as an independent nation has been assimilated, all its land is open for buying, selling, digging, and building waterworks.

6 THE RAINY SEASON

6.1 DIVIDING THE WATER

Finally, water flows down the rivers, starting at the sources. The main rivers are handled one by one in the order indicated on the map. Put a number of blue water markers at the source of each of the three rivers. The amount of water per source depends on the current era (see the drops on the board).

Start by moving the main water flow of river 1 downstream. At a river confluence, the water from one tributary should wait until the other tributary has brought in its water.

If water reaches a waterwork, the monarch of the state that operates the waterwork must decide what to do with the water.

If the water reaches a reservoir, this reservoir must pump water equal to its capacity to a neighboring area connected by a direct canal. It may distribute the water among different neighboring areas, as long as it is connected to each of them. A M(ill)-reservoir has unlimited capacity and must therefore distribute all water it gets.

If the water reaches a pump, this pump can distribute the water over the indicated distance measured along canals, but not past other pumps. A pump can distribute any amount of water. It can also pump water to another pump within reach, which may then pump the water even further. A Mill (M-pump) can distribute water over any distance, but still it cannot pump past other pumps.

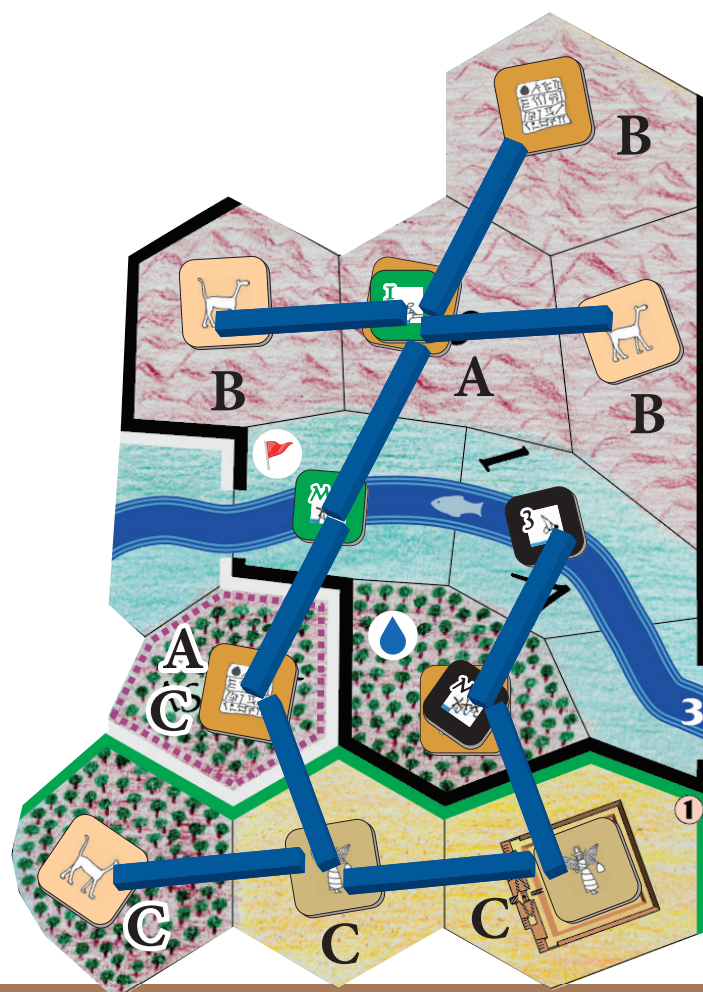
Land is irrigated by putting a water marker on it. An area can be irrigated only if it is owned by a player. Each land can only be irrigated once. To irrigate land, a state must be able to reach it using reservoirs and/or pumps. The monarch owning the waterwork puts one water marker on the area.

A state may choose which lands to irrigate. However, the monarch controlling a pump is obliged to get rid of as much water as possible: they must either irrigate as much land as they can or pump the water to a pump, of any state, where it has not yet been. In addition, a pump must always irrigate the area it is on if the area is owned by a player. If a pump brings water to an area containing another pump, the latter will irrigate the area (if it is owned by a player).

Note that it is possible to pump water across an area without irrigating it. For example, if there is a canal from area A to area B and from area B to area C, with a 2-pump on area A, then the pump can bring water to area C without irrigating area B. Area B does not need to be owned by a player, but to irrigate area B it must have an owner.

If a pump has excess water (because there was no more land left to irrigate), the water returns to the previous pump, which must either use it to irrigate land or send the water to a pump where it has not yet been.

Eventually, if there is more water in the canal stretch than land that can be irrigated, the excess water is returned to the reservoir from where it originated. If possible, the reservoir must now redistribute it among the other land areas it is connected to. If this



Mills example. The M-reservoir at  can pump any amount of water, but it can only reach the areas marked A. Using the 1-pump to the North, water can be brought to each of the three lands marked B as well. - The 3-reservoir can pump 3 water to the M-pump at  this pump must use 1 water to irrigate its own land and pump 2 water to two of the lands to which there is a direct connection (marked C).

also fails, the excess joins the main water flow, which flows downstream again until it encounters the next reservoir.

A pump or reservoir may not pump water directly into the river, across a river or into a reservoir.

If no water flows out of the downmost area of the river, leaving the map, the Southern Peoples invade the land and the game ends as soon as the rainy season has been completed.

6.2 HARVESTS

Owners of irrigated areas get 5 SPL per irrigated area, or 10 SPL for a city.

A state irrigates an area if it owns the final pump or reservoir in the series that has brought water to that area. If an area contains a pump, the state that owns that pump is said to irrigate the area.

A state harvests a certain amount of food for each area it irrigates. The amount varies between 20 and 30 SPL, depending on the current era (see the numbers on the squares under the stacks of cards on the game board). The amount is doubled for cities.

6.2.1 Storing or Distributing the Harvests

After irrigation is complete and the harvests have been collected, the monarch of each active state now announces what to do with its harvest. Monarchs make this announcement in the order indicated by the hourglasses in the row on the board.

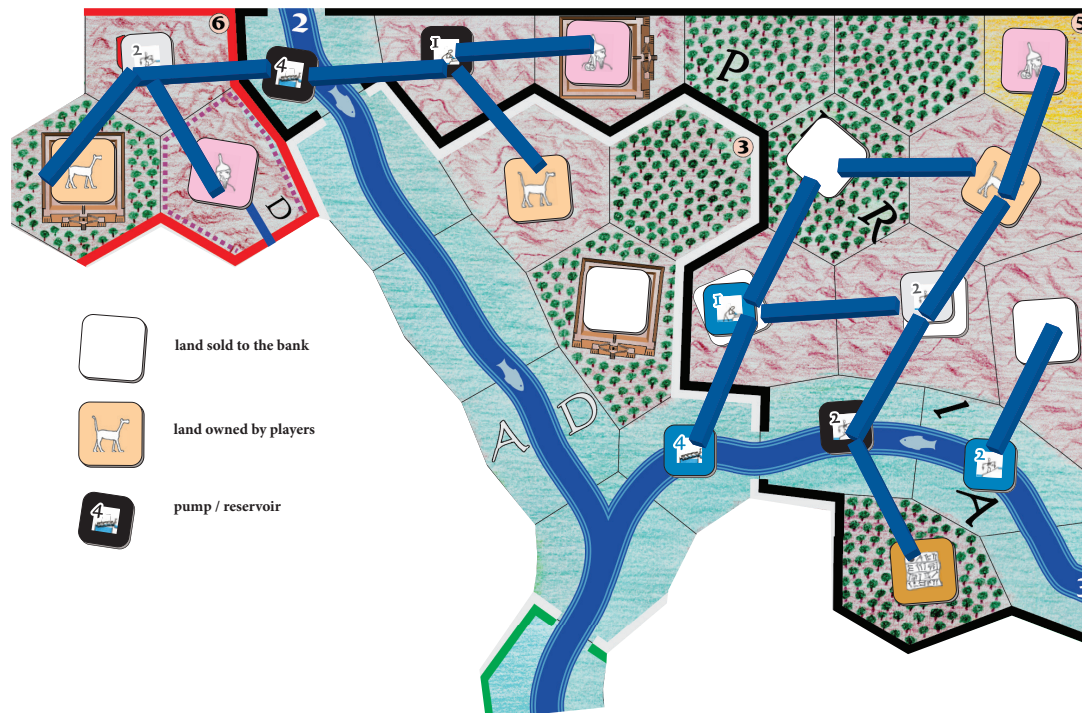
The harvest can either be stored or divided among the landowners. If the harvest is divided, each area in the state (whether it was irrigated or not) gets an equal share. Round down before multiplying and put any remaining money in the state treasury. Exception: if only one player has land in the state, they get the entire harvest. Note that ownership of an independent nation does not qualify as ownership of that nation's land area(s).

If the harvest is stored, all money goes to the treasury. However, the monarch must remove one of the state's waterworks with the

lowest printed number from the map. Mills can never be removed, even if the state only has mills and stores its harvest.

No waterwork has to be removed if there is no harvest at all.

For example: suppose Akkad harvests 75 SPL. Tamara has 4 areas in Akkad; Frank has 3. Nobody else owns land in Akkad. The total number of player-owned areas in Akkad is $3 + 4 = 7$, so each area will earn its owner $75 / 7 = 10$ SPL (round down!). Queen Tamara decides to distribute the harvest and gets $4 \times 10 = 40$ SPL; Frank gets $3 \times 10 = 30$ SPL. The remaining 5 SPL go into the state treasury of Akkad. - Harry owns six areas in Babylon, where nobody else has land. Babylon harvests 50 SPL. If Monarch Harry distributes the harvest, he must put the full amount of 50 SPL into his private treasury.



Rainy season example. It is era 3. Put six water at river 1 (not shown), six water at river 2 and six water at river 3. Start with river 1 (not shown). Next allow water to flow down river 2. The water reaches the 4-reservoir. The owner may choose to send water either east or west, or both. As he owns the 1- pump, he sends water east. The 1-pump diverts two water to the surrounding fields and uses one water to irrigate its own land. One water is put back on the reservoir, which has to pump it west. The 2-pump has to irrigate its own land. The state owning the 1-pump gets $2 \times \text{SPL } 25 + 1 \times \text{SPL } 50$ (city site) = SPL 100; the state owning the 2- pump gets SPL 25; the landowners each get SPL 5, except for the city-site owner, who gets SPL 10. The rest of the water flows down the river, reaches the junction, and waits for water from river 3 to arrive. Water now flows down river 3 and reaches the first 2- reservoir. As there are no canals leading to other

pumps or sold land, it cannot divert any water. The water then reaches the second reservoir of capacity 2. This reservoir sends one water to the south, irrigating that area. The other water is diverted to the pump in the north, which must use it to irrigate any of the areas within two steps (marked "A"). The rest of the water then reaches the 4-reservoir, which must try to divert four water. It can only send them to the 1-pump, which cannot irrigate any lands itself as all sold land is too far away. The 1-pump sends the water to the 2-pump, which irrigates the land marked "A" which had not yet been irrigated. The rest of the water is put back in the 4-reservoir. By now, the water of river 3 has earned the state controlling the 2-pump $2 \times \text{SPL } 25 = \text{SPL } 50$; the state owning the second 2-reservoir earned SPL 25; the three landowners each earned SPL 5. The rest of the water flows down, reaches the junction and then flows down together with the water at the junction.

6.3 EFFECT OF IRRIGATION ON LAND

PRICES

All types of land increase in value by a number of steps equal to the number of regions of that type that were irrigated this turn. A region is a continuous group of land areas of the same type. There are thus 5 regions of hills, 4 of desert and forest, and 3 of savannah.

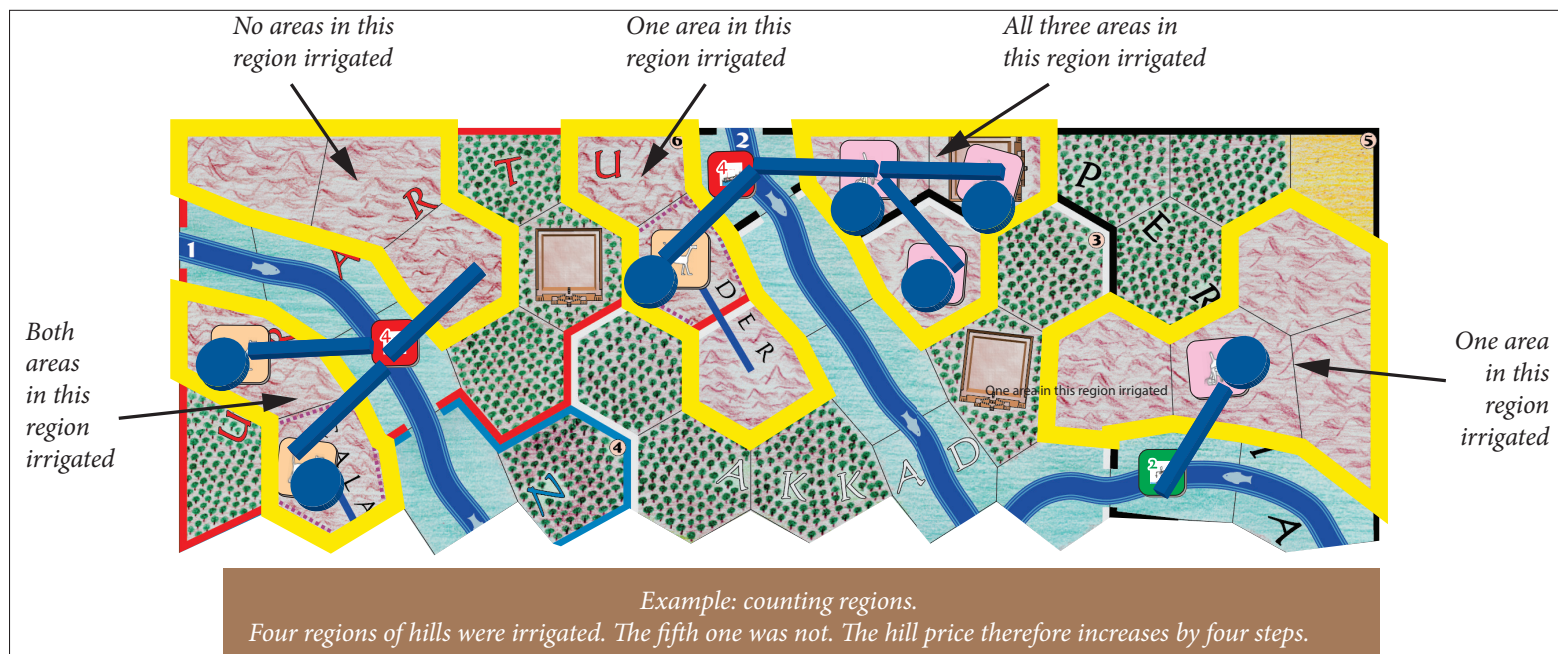
After the prices have been adjusted, remove the water markers from the board, and play proceeds with the settlement phase of the next round; the player who has the primogeniture card starts.

7 GAME END

The game ends at the end of the rainy season, if:

- a revolution has occurred because a monarch cannot maintain the waterworks, or
- an invasion of the Southern Peoples occurs because no water flows off the board from the Southernmost river area, meaning all water was used for irrigation.

When the game ends, the player with the most valuable set of assets wins the game. Only private money and land value count for a player's assets. State treasuries and independent nations are not counted.



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9 LIST OF INDEPENDENT NATIONS

9.1 ASHUR

Price: 20 SPL

Yield per round: 10 SPL

Special properties: none. Cannot be dissolved by a state, but can be assimilated.

9.2 BARAHSHUM

Price: 40 SPL

Yield per round: 20 SPL

Special properties: The owning player or state may dissolve the nation to dig a canal from the Barahshum homeland to any adjacent area; in doing so, it may create one or two junctions. A player may dissolve Barahshum at any time during the settlement phase, or in between states in the development phase. This may be used in the same way by a state after assimilation, but only in the state's turn in the development phase.

9.3 CALAH

Price: 70 SPL

Yield per round: 25 SPL

Special properties: The owning state may dissolve Calah for a free waterwork of the current type in the hills of Calah or any areas adjacent to Calah during its turn. Normal rules apply (waterwork card discarded; land owner must give permission; no more than one waterwork per land).

9.4 DER

Price: 110 SPL

Yield per round: 30 SPL

Special properties: May be dissolved by a player to buy one available forest land at no cost during the player's turn in the settlement

phase. This counts as the turn's buy action. No money goes into the state treasury. The state is not compensated in any way. The land may be a normal or city forest area. Cannot be dissolved by a state, but can be assimilated.

9.5 ERIDU

Price: 160 SPL

Yield per round: 35 SPL

Special properties: Eridu can be used to dig canals before the states operate. Eridu acts as a 2-digging crew in all respects and is controlled by the owning player or the monarch of the controlling state. Each round, it may dig before any of the state diggers, even if it is owned by a state. Using this special property does not cause Eridu to be dissolved.

A state owning Eridu need not have another digging crew. If a player owns Eridu, it does not relieve any of the states for which that player is monarch of the obligation to have a digging crew.

9.6 FIRST AKKADIANS

Price: 220 SPL

Yield per round: 35 SPL

Special properties: The money paid for this nation goes into the state of Akkad. The player who bought the First Akkadians immediately gets three Savannah lands in the state of Akkad. Unlike other independent nations, these fields can be owned by a player while the First Akkadians is an independent nation owned by a player.

This independent nation dissolves as soon as the state of Akkad hires a digging crew (assimilating Eridu does not count as hiring a digging crew).

The First Akkadians cannot be assimilated.

10 TECHNOLOGICAL DEVELOPMENT SCHEME

Era	Number of cards	Capacity (and price) reservoirs	Reach (and price) pumps	Quality (and price) diggers	Water supply per river	Yield/area for irrigating state (land owner)	Special events at dawn of era
1	10	2 (30)	1 (30)	1+1 (50)	6	20 (5)	None
2	8	4 (80)	2 (80)	2 (100)	6	20 (5)	None
3	7	6 (100)	3 (100)	3 (150)	6	25 (5)	All 1+1-diggers disappear. Independent nations may be assimilated.
4	5	8 (150)	4 (150)	4 (200)	7	25 (5)	All 2-diggers disappear. Independent nations disappear.
M	unlimited (8 provided)	M (200)	M (200)	M (400)	8	30 (5)	All 3-diggers disappear.